

MJ and the Wobbly Days

Production Handoff Pack for Ihab — v1

Prepared for: Ihab

Prepared by: Hasan

Project: *MJ and the Wobbly Days*

Status: Character approved, book structure approved, image production not yet stable.

1. Project Objective

We are creating a 32-page children's picture book titled:

MJ and the Wobbly Days

Subtitle:

A story about courage, difference, and living with MS

Author line:

Written by MJ Donnellan

The book is for children aged **3–6**.

The main creative challenge is **visual consistency**.

We already have an approved main character, MJ, but AI image tools repeatedly drift when generating full scenes. The purpose of this handoff is to create a cleaner production workflow that protects MJ's consistency across every page.

2. Core Story

MJ is a warm orange character who loves movement.

At the start of the book, MJ dances, spins, runs, and feels free.

Then something changes.

Her legs feel strange, heavy, and wobbly. Her hands drop things. She wakes up tired. Eventually she is diagnosed with Multiple Sclerosis.

The story explains MS gently for young children using the metaphor of “bad phone reception” between the brain and body.

The book then explores:

- hidden symptoms
- being misunderstood
- hard days
- asking for help
- creativity
- kindness
- difference
- self-acceptance

The central message is:

Different does not mean less.

The emotional ending is:

**Being different was never something to hide.
It was something to honour.**

3. Locked Book Decisions

These decisions are final.

Title

MJ and the Wobbly Days

Do not change to:

- MJ's Different Journey
- MJ's MS Journey
- MJ's Brave Journey
- any alternate title

Subtitle

A story about courage, difference, and living with MS

Author line

Written by MJ Donnellan

Target age

3–6 years old

Format

Interior illustrations should be:

A5 landscape ratio

Aspect ratio:

1.414:1 landscape

No square images.

No portrait images.

Text

Do **not** place manuscript text inside generated images.

Text will be added later during layout.

Every illustration must leave a clean text-safe zone.

Page count

The current working structure is:

32 interior pages

The external cover is separate.

4. MJ Character Bible

MJ v1.0 is approved and frozen.

MJ must remain the same character in every image.

MJ is

- warm orange
- fluffy but not shaggy
- compact and pear-shaped
- rounded and child-friendly
- expressive

- gentle
- playful
- vulnerable
- brave
- suitable for ages 3–6

MJ has

- large expressive brown eyes
- white sclera
- catchlights
- small curved eyebrows
- freckles on both cheeks
- upward orange hair tufts
- soft orange fur
- rounded pear-shaped body
- short rounded arms
- short rounded legs
- simple rounded hands
- simple rounded feet

MJ must not become

- tall
- slim
- elongated
- bean-shaped
- smooth and flat
- overly shaggy
- baby-like
- human-like
- animal-like
- mascot-like
- superhero-like
- realistic
- a different orange creature

The most important rule:

If MJ does not look like the approved MJ v1.0, the image fails, even if the scene is beautiful.

5. MJ Visual Fidelity Gate

Before approving any image, judge MJ first.

Do not judge background first.

Do not judge lighting first.

Do not judge composition first.

Ask:

1. Does MJ match MJ_CANON_01?
2. Does MJ match the approved turnaround sheet?
3. Is MJ still compact and pear-shaped?
4. Are the eyes, freckles, hair, face, fur, and body proportions consistent?
5. Are the arms and legs short and rounded?
6. Is MJ free of unapproved clothing?
7. Does MJ still feel like the same character from the approved references?

If any answer is no, reject the image.

6. Approved Reference Images

Hasan will provide these as files.

Canonical Character References

MJ_CANON_01

Primary approved MJ reference.

Use this as the highest character authority.

Controls:

- face
- body shape
- orange colour
- fur texture
- freckles
- eyes
- hair tufts
- hands
- feet
- proportions

MJ v1.0 Turnaround Sheet

Approved character turnaround showing:

- front view
- left view
- right view
- back view
- three-quarter view
- happy
- curious
- worried

- sad
- brave
- thoughtful
- proud

This is the official production model sheet.

MJ_CANON_SUPPORT_01

Approved running/movement reference.

Use only for:

- movement energy
- joyful action
- outdoor freedom

Do not let this override MJ_CANON_01's proportions.

7. Approved Style Anchors

Hasan will provide approved images.

These images define the book's illustration style:

Approved Page 1

Interior title page style.

- soft cream background
- orange ribbon motif
- calm welcoming mood
- clean text-safe zone

Approved Page 2

Joyful movement.

- soft warm abstract background
- MJ energetic
- open text-safe space

Approved Page 3

Kitchen dancing/spinning.

- warm home lighting
- socks only because manuscript mentions socks

- indoor movement style

Approved Page 4 test

Outdoor running/twirling.

- grass
- sky
- flowers
- joyful freedom
- playful motion

Approved Page 10 test

Hospital comfort.

- soft hospital colours
- mum comforting MJ
- safe, not scary

Approved Page 22 test

Messy storm painting.

- art room
- orange swirls
- emotional creativity
- cousin watching

Approved Page 30 test

Stars ending.

- night window
- warm lamp
- peaceful hope

8. Rejected Image Bible

Rejected images must be placed in a separate folder:

99_REJECTED_DO_NOT_USE

Do not use rejected images as reference unless doing a forensic audit.

Reject anything with:

- wrong title
 - purple MS ribbon
 - generic orange mascot
 - flat motion-bible cartoon style
 - MJ wearing unapproved clothing
 - MJ becoming yellow
 - MJ becoming tall/slim
 - MJ becoming overly shaggy
 - MJ becoming baby-like
 - MJ changing face shape
 - MJ changing fur texture
 - baked-in text
 - slogans
 - collage/grid outputs
 - square or portrait ratio
 - hospital version with clothes
 - failed motion bible sheets
 - failed Page 5 versions where MJ drifted
-

9. Drawing Style Bible

The book style is:

warm modern children's picture-book illustration

It should feel:

- soft
- painterly
- gentle
- rounded
- emotionally clear
- warm
- safe
- suitable for ages 3–6

It should not feel:

- anime
- comic-book
- glossy 3D toy
- Pixar-like unless softened heavily
- realistic
- medical poster
- educational infographic
- superhero
- horror

- cold clinical
- flat model-sheet cartoon

Rendering style

Use soft painterly digital illustration.

MJ and the background must look like they belong in the same world.

Avoid:

- highly detailed MJ with blurry background
 - watercolour background with glossy MJ
 - pasted-on character look
 - mismatched lighting
 - mismatched brush texture
-

10. Colour Bible

MJ

MJ must stay warm orange.

Do not shift MJ toward:

- yellow
- red
- brown
- peach skin tone
- neon orange
- dark burnt orange

Overall palette

Use:

- warm cream
- soft yellow
- peach
- sky blue
- gentle green
- warm brown
- pale hospital blue
- soft night blues

MS ribbon rule

All MS ribbons must be orange.

Never purple.

Prefer avoiding ribbons inside story pages unless needed.

11. Lighting Bible

Happy/opening pages

- warm sunlight
- bright but soft
- playful
- not overexposed

Home pages

- warm indoor light
- cosy
- safe
- soft shadows

Hospital pages

- clean but not cold
- cream and pale blue
- warm safety
- no harsh clinical lighting

Hard/sad pages

- slightly muted colours
- gentle shadows
- never frightening
- never bleak

Night/stars pages

- soft moonlight/starlight
 - warm indoor lamp light
 - peaceful, not spooky
-

12. Layout Bible

All final page illustrations:

- A5 landscape
- 1.414:1

- one page only
- no collage
- no grid
- no multiple panels
- no text inside image
- no title inside image
- no labels
- no slogans

Text-safe zone

Every page must reserve:

30–40% clean text-safe space

The text-safe zone must be:

- low detail
- softly coloured
- free of MJ
- free of faces
- free of important objects
- free of busy patterns
- suitable for large readable children's text

Odd/even page rule

Odd-numbered pages sit on the **right-hand side**.

For odd pages:

- inner/gutter side = left
- safer text zone = right/outside side

Even-numbered pages sit on the **left-hand side**.

For even pages:

- inner/gutter side = right
- safer text zone = left/outside side

Avoid putting important text close to the gutter.

13. Clothing and Prop Bible

MJ normally wears no clothing.

Approved exception:

Page 3

MJ may wear simple socks because the manuscript says:

“She spun across the kitchen floor in her socks.”

Socks must be:

- simple
- cream/off-white
- not distracting
- no patterns
- no shoes

Do not add:

- shirt
- pants
- dress
- apron
- hospital gown
- jeans
- human outfit

Props

Props are allowed only if story-required.

Examples:

- paintbrush for painting page
- dropped object for hands-dropping page
- canvas for messy storm page
- bed/chair/window as scene objects

Props must never change MJ.

14. Supporting Character Bible

Supporting characters should be warm, gentle, and secondary.

They must not overpower MJ.

Mum

- warm
- protective
- gentle

- emotionally safe
- not overdramatic
- not too realistic
- soft children's-book style

Doctor

- female doctor
- short hair
- kind
- approachable
- calm
- not frightening
- not cold
- no scary medical tools

Cousin

- young child
- curious
- gentle
- warm
- should not dominate messy storm scene

Classroom children

- diverse but simple
- child-friendly
- soft style
- MJ remains visual/emotional focus

15. Production Pipeline Recommendation

The previous AI workflow failed when trying to generate MJ and background together for difficult scenes.

The best workflow is now:

Session 1 — MJ Pose Library

Create MJ only.

- one pose at a time
- plain cream background
- no scene
- no text
- no props unless absolutely essential
- no supporting characters

Approval question:

Does this look like MJ v1.0?

Session 2 — Background Library

Create scene backgrounds only.

- no MJ
- no characters unless necessary
- A5 landscape
- correct text-safe zone
- correct odd/even layout
- leave space where MJ will be placed

Session 3 — Composite

Combine:

- approved MJ pose
- approved background

Do not redraw MJ.

Only adjust:

- scale
- placement
- lighting harmony
- contact shadow
- edge blending

This reduces character drift.

16. Unreal / 3D Feasibility Note

Unreal Engine can help with consistency only if we first create a reusable 3D MJ asset.

Unreal itself will not automatically create MJ.

A proper 3D pipeline would require:

1. Create MJ as a 3D model.
2. Rig MJ.
3. Create facial expressions.
4. Create poses.
5. Render MJ from any angle.
6. Apply a soft storybook shader.

7. Composite renders into book scenes.

This could be powerful if MJ becomes a long-term character for:

- books
- animation
- social media
- merchandise
- future projects

But for this book alone, it may be too heavy unless Ihab can help with 3D setup.

Recommended test:

Create one 3D MJ prototype and compare it to MJ_CANON_01.

If it loses the soul of MJ, stop.

If it works, Unreal may become the consistency engine.

17. 32-Page Structure

External cover is separate.

Page 1 — Interior Title Page

Text context:

“MJ and the Wobbly Days

A story about courage, difference, and living with MS”

Scene:

Quiet title-page illustration. MJ on left. Orange ribbon motif. Large clean title space.

Page 2

Text:

“MJ loved to move.”

Scene:

MJ joyful, energetic, mid-movement.

Page 3

Text:

"She danced while breakfast cooked.
She spun across the kitchen floor in her socks."

Scene:

Warm kitchen. MJ dancing/spinning. Socks allowed.

Page 4

Text:

"She ran barefoot through the grass.
She twirled until the world went dizzy and fell into giggles.
Movement made MJ feel free."

Scene:

Outdoor grass. Barefoot running/twirling. Joyful freedom.

Page 5

Text:

"Until one day...

something changed."

Scene:

MJ pauses mid-step in a familiar home space.

Page 6

Text:

"Her legs felt strange.

Heavy.

Wobbly."

Scene:

MJ's legs feel unstable/heavy. Gentle uncertainty, not slapstick.

Page 7

Text:

"Her hands dropped things she was sure she was holding.

And some mornings, MJ woke up tired before the day had even begun."

Scene:

Dropped object / tired morning. May need split composition but no collage unless designed carefully.

Page 8

Text:

"At first, nobody understood.

Not even MJ.

'Maybe you just need more sleep,' people said.

'Maybe you're doing too much.'"

Scene:

MJ feeling misunderstood. Other voices implied, not necessarily shown.

Page 9

Text:

"But MJ knew.

Something didn't feel right."

Scene:

MJ quiet, inward, knowing something is wrong.

Page 10

Text:

"Then one day, after her legs shook and her eyes went blurry, MJ found herself in a big hospital room, holding her mum's hand so tightly her fingers hurt."

Scene:

Hospital room. MJ holding mum's hand. Safe, not scary.

Page 11

Text:

"That was the day the doctors said words MJ had never heard before:

Multiple Sclerosis.

MS."

Scene:

Doctor gently explaining. MJ and mum present. No scary medical imagery.

Page 12

Text:

"Her mum rubbed circles on her hand.

'What does that mean?' MJ whispered."

Scene:

Close emotional support between MJ and mum.

Page 13

Text:

"The doctor smiled kindly.

'It means the messages from your brain to your body sometimes get a little mixed up.'"

Scene:

Kind female doctor explaining gently. Could include soft visual metaphor.

Page 14

Text:

"MJ blinked.

'Like bad phone reception?'

The doctor laughed softly.

'A little bit like that.'

Scene:

Gentle child-friendly brain/body signal metaphor. No technical diagrams.

Page 15

Text:

"Sometimes MS made walking harder.

Sometimes it made MJ tired.

Sometimes sore.

Sometimes shaky.

And sometimes scared."

Scene:

MJ walking carefully / feeling symptoms. Safe and gentle.

Page 16

Text:

"'Will I always be different?' MJ asked quietly.

Her mum squeezed her hand.

'Yes,' she said gently.

'But different does not mean less.'

Scene:

MJ and mum in quiet emotional moment.

Page 17

Text:

"That didn't make everything easier.

There were still hard days.

Days MJ fell over.

Days her legs wouldn't listen.

Days she cried because her body felt cross with her."

Scene:

Hard day after stumble. Gentle, not dramatic.

Page 18

Text:

"Days people said things that hurt.

'But you don't look sick.'"

Scene:

MJ hurt by words. Other people may be implied softly.

Page 19

Text:

"MJ wished they could see what she felt.

The aching in her legs.

The tiredness behind her smile.

The fear that came when she had to walk across a room by herself."

Scene:

MJ facing a room/crossing distance. Hidden symptoms.

Page 20

Text:

"But little by little...

MJ learned something.

She was still MJ.

Still funny.

Still brave.

Still full of colour.

Still full of dreams."

Scene:

Self-recognition. Warm hope. MJ with colour/light.

Page 21

Text:

"On wobbly days, she moved slower.

On tired days, she rested.

On hard days, she asked for help."

Scene:

Self-care montage feeling, but avoid busy collage. Could use one strong image of rest/help/moving slowly.

Page 22

Text:

"And one afternoon, while painting swirls of bright orange across a canvas, her little cousin asked:

'What are you making?'

MJ smiled.

'My messy storm.'"

Scene:

Art room. MJ painting orange swirls. Cousin watches.

Page 23

Text:

"Her cousin frowned.

'It looks sunny too.'

MJ grinned.

'It can be both.'"

Scene:

Cousin looking at painting. Sunny/stormy duality.

Page 24

Text:

"That made her cousin think very hard.

Then he smiled.

'Oh.'

And maybe life could be like that too."

Scene:

Reflection between MJ, cousin, painting.

Page 25

Text:

"Hard and beautiful.

Scary and brave.

Different and wonderful."

Scene:

Symbolic emotional page. Warm, simple, poetic.

Page 26

Text:

"Soon MJ began sharing her story.

She told children that some differences are easy to see...

and some are hidden."

Scene:

MJ speaking gently to children.

Page 27

Text:

"Some people use wheelchairs.

Some wear hearing aids.

Some need medicine.

Some need extra rest.

And everyone deserves kindness."

Scene:

Inclusive children/community scene. Keep age-appropriate and simple.

Page 28

Text:

"One little girl raised her hand.

'So being different isn't bad?'

MJ smiled.

'No.'"

Scene:

Child asking question. MJ reassuring.

Page 29

Text:

"She looked around the room.

'Different just means we all have different stories.'

A quiet voice whispered from the back:

'That makes the world more interesting.'"

Scene:

Classroom/group warmth. Children listening.

Page 30

Text:

"MJ felt tears sting her eyes.

Because once, she thought being different meant something was wrong with her.

But maybe...

it just meant her story looked different."

Scene:

MJ emotionally moved. Gentle tears, not despair.

Page 31

Text:

"That night, MJ stood at her window looking at the stars.

Her legs hurt.

Her body was tired.

But her heart felt full."

Scene:

MJ at window. Night stars. Tired but peaceful.

Page 32

Text:

"Because even on the wobbly days...

she was still learning.

Still growing.

Still shining.

And being different?

That was never something to hide.

That was something to honour."

Scene:

Final hopeful image. MJ peaceful/proud. Stars or warm glow. No magical cure.

18. Pose Library Needed

Create these as separate MJ-only pose cards.

Do not create a giant pose sheet.

Approved / Needed Poses

1. Paused mid-step, uncertain
2. Heavy legs / wobbly standing
3. Dropping something
4. Tired morning
5. Alone and confused
6. Quiet inner knowing
7. Holding / reaching for mum's hand
8. Asking worried question
9. Curious understanding
10. Walking carefully
11. Tired / sore / shaky
12. Vulnerable with mum
13. Hard day after stumble
14. Hurt by words
15. Afraid to cross a room
16. Still MJ / self-recognition
17. Moving slowly
18. Resting
19. Asking for help
20. Painting gesture
21. Looking at painting thoughtfully
22. Sharing story gently
23. Answering child's question
24. Emotionally moved, tears in eyes

- 25. Standing at window, tired but peaceful
- 26. Looking up at stars
- 27. Peaceful proud / honour

Each pose card must show:

- one MJ only
 - plain cream background
 - no scene
 - no text
 - no labels
 - no grid
 - no collage
 - no full supporting character
 - no unapproved clothing
-

19. Final Production Rule

The project fails if MJ drifts.

A beautiful page with the wrong MJ is not usable.

A simple page with correct MJ can be improved.

Therefore:

Character fidelity first.

Scene beauty second.

Text layout third.

20. Folder Structure for Ihab

Use this folder structure:

MJ_BOOK_PRODUCTION/

01_MANUSCRIPT/

- locked_manuscript.txt
- 32_page_structure.txt

02_CHARACTER_CANON/

- MJ_CANON_01_primary.png
- MJ_v1_turnaround_sheet.png
- MJ_CANON_SUPPORT_01_running.png

03_APPROVED_STYLE_ANCHORS/

- page_01_approved.png
- page_02_approved.png
- page_03_approved.png
- page_04_test_approved.png
- page_10_test_approved.png
- page_22_test_approved.png
- page_30_test_approved.png

04_REJECTED_DO_NOT_USE/

- failed_motion_bible/
- failed_page_5/
- clothing_drift/
- style_drift/
- wrong_title/
- purple_ribbon/

05_POSE_LIBRARY/

- pose_01_paused_mid_step.png
- pose_02_heavy_wobbly_legs.png
- etc

06_BACKGROUND_LIBRARY/

- bg_page_01.png
- bg_page_02.png
- etc

07_COMPOSITES/

- page_01_composite.png
- page_02_composite.png
- etc

08_FINAL_LAYOUT/

- print_pdf/
- proof_pdf/
- text_layout_files/

09_NOTES/

- approval_log.txt
 - change_log.txt
 - issue_log.txt
-

21. Approval Log Template

For every image, log:

Image name: Page number: Date: Status: Approved / Rejected / Needs revision

MJ fidelity: Pass / Fail

Style consistency: Pass / Fail

Text-safe zone: Pass / Fail

Aspect ratio: Pass / Fail

Reason for rejection: Notes: Next action:

22. Summary for Ihab

The main problem is not generating nice images.

The main problem is keeping MJ consistent.

We have already achieved a strong approved MJ design, but full-scene AI generation causes drift.

Recommended solution:

1. Lock MJ references.
2. Create MJ poses separately.
3. Create backgrounds separately.
4. Composite.
5. Only then do final layout.

Do not rush into generating all 32 pages at once.

The book should be built like a production pipeline, not like random image prompts.